QP CODE: **25900377**

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION, OCTOBER 2025

THIRD SEMESTER

MG3VACENG200 - **LITERATURE AND GENDER**

Instructions to the examiner:

Do consider the individuality of your classroom experiences; encourage students' creativity and originality. All answers that make contextual sense could be given marks.

Scheme of Valuation

PART A

1. **c)** By arguing for equality while acknowledging sexual difference as real and lived **[CO1].**
2. **b)** Public duty is challenged by the authentic expressions of **gender** and sexuality, leading to transformative choices (the word gender is typed wrong in QP; marks should be given according to your discretion) **[CO2]**.
3. **b)** Skins fish, sweeps, and washes clothes **[CO3].**
4. **b)** Blending masculine and feminine styles in clothing **[CO1]**.
5. **b)** Crime scene **[CO3]**.

(1 x 5 = 5)

PART B

6. According to Butler, the subject is not a pre-existing entity that performs; instead, subjectivity emerges through performance and discourse **[CO1]**.
7. In Virginia Woolf's novel, Orlando's aristocratic position provides access to literary circles, education, and freedom from economic necessity. At the same time, Orlando's homoerotic desires and eventual gender transformation represent desires impossible within heteronormative bourgeois marriage structures **[CO2]**.
8. In Arundhati Roy's *The God of Small Things* (1997), the concept of "Love Laws" functions as the central mechanism through which caste, class, and gender hierarchies are maintained and policed in postcolonial Kerala. The laws decree that cross-caste romantic or sexual relationships constitute the most severe transgression of social order **[CO3]**.
9. Victorian and patriarchal frameworks conceptualised female sexuality as something requiring suppression for maintaining social order, morality, and masculine authority.
   Female sexuality as dangerous - Public/private dichotomy - Medicalisation (women's sexuality was pathologised) - Compliance through shame **[CO1]**.
10. Virginia Woolf's conceptualisation of identity prefigures contemporary intersectional approaches by resisting singular, unified identity categories.
    Fluidity and multiplicity - Rejection of essential categories - Material conditions and consciousness **[CO2]**.

11. Nyasha exists within irreconcilable cultural demands - the colonial mission school education valorises "European" femininity, individualism, and intellectual development, while Shona family structures emphasise female submission, duty, and communal belonging. The psychological distress emerges from being educated beyond "appropriate" femininity while remaining subject to patriarchal control **[CO3]**.

12. Gender identity refers to an individual's internal, deeply felt sense of their own gender, which may or may not correspond to the sex assigned at birth. It encompasses how one understands, experiences, and expresses oneself as masculine, feminine, non-binary, or otherwise gendered. Recognition of lived experience - Moving beyond essentialism- Inclusion and equity - Understanding oppression- Intersectionality **[CO1]**.

13. In *Red, White & Royal Blue* by Casey, public spectacle functions as a crucial mechanism for negotiating queer identity, romance, and political change in contemporary neoliberal contexts. Visibility as power and vulnerability - Media spectacle as political intervention - Consumption and commodification - Generational and cultural significance - Inclusive visibility **[CO2]**.

14. The tension between tradition and modernity forms the core structural conflict in *Nervous Conditions*, experienced acutely by female characters caught between Shona customary practices and colonial "civilisation." Tambu's pursuit of modernity through the mission school produces psychological conflict and self-estrangement. Unable to synthesise these contradictions, Nysha experiences psychological fragmentation and self-harm. Maiguru represents an older generation attempting adaptation rather than resolution **[CO3]**.

(5 x 6 = 30)

PART C

15. Ernest Hemingway's *The Sun Also Rises* (1926), also published as *Fiesta*, follows Jake Barnes and his circle of expatriate friends in post-World War I Europe. The novel traces Jake's relationship with Lady Brett Ashley, an aristocratic English woman separated from her husband, who circulates through the expatriate community in Paris. Jake loves Brett, but their relationship remains unconsummated - Jake's war wound has left him sexually impotent, creating the novel's central tragedy. The opening establishes the aimless hedonism of 1920s expatriate lifein Paris. Jake and his friends (Robert Cohn, Bill Gorton, and others) drift through bars, cafés, and social gatherings. Brett arrives, and her charismatic presence magnetises the group. The central action involves the group's trip to Pamplona for the San Fermín festival and bullfighting. This pilgrimage represents both retreat from modern urban life and confrontation with authentic passion and danger through bullfighting's spectacle. During the festival, complex romantic dynamics emerge. Robert Cohn, an American writer, attempts to claim Brett as his lover, but she leaves him for Pedro Romero, a young, beautiful bullfighter. Jake experiences acute jealousy and pain. Bill Gorton offers comic relief and commentary on the destructive romance **[CO3]**.

16. Appropriate answers should be awarded marks **[CO2]**.

17. Appropriate answers should be awarded marks **[CO3]**.

(15 x 1 = 15)